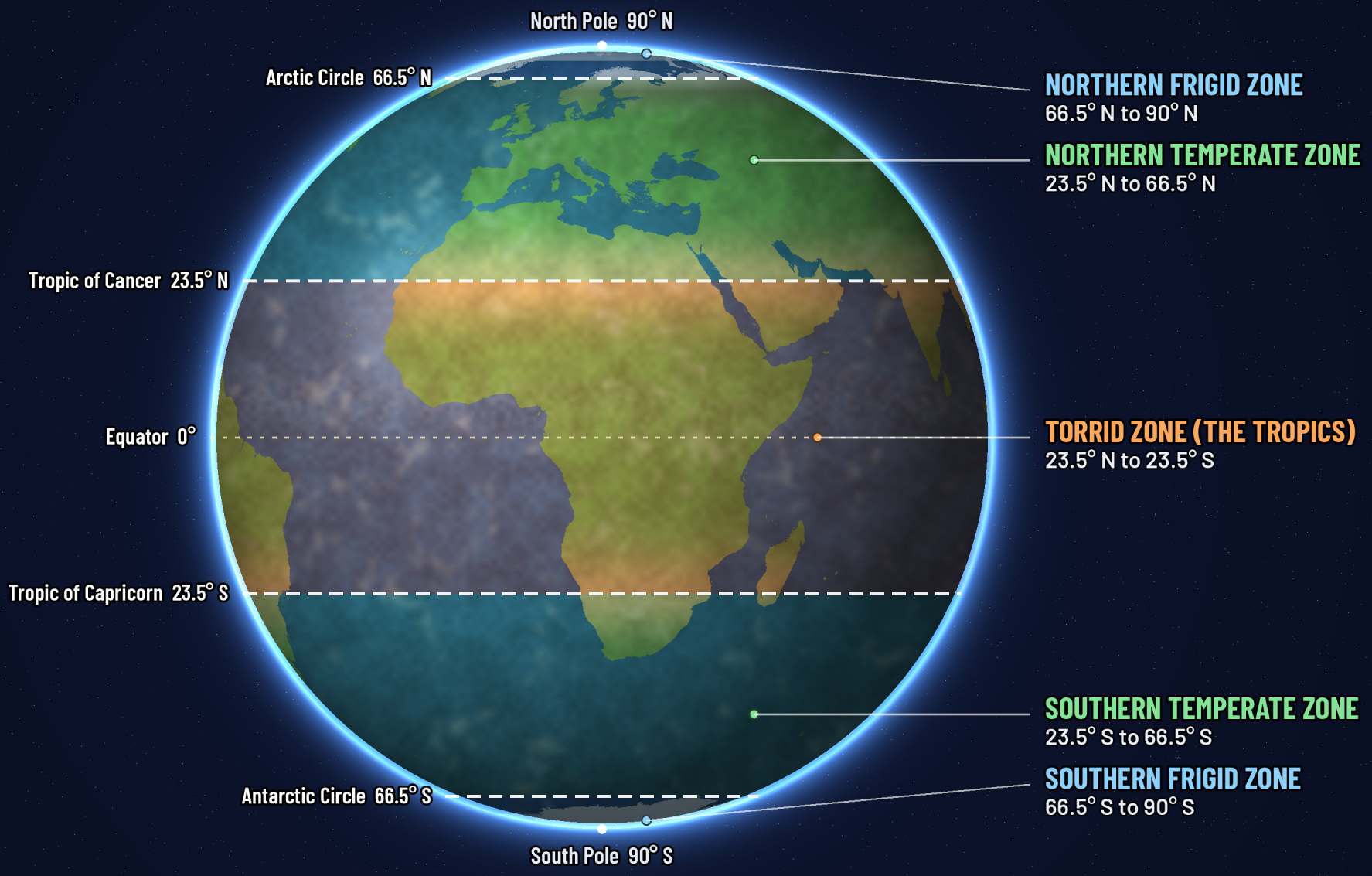
ARISTOTLE'S FIVE CLIMATIC ZONES

Broad astronomical belts set by Earth's 23.5° axial tilt



WHY THESE LINES?

The tropics mark the farthest north and south the Sun can appear directly overhead.

The polar circles mark the limits of 24-hour summer daylight and 24-hour winter darkness.

WHERE THE IDEA CAME FROM

Aristotle described the five zones, building on earlier Greek ideas. The geographer Strabo credits Parmenides with originating them.

"TEMPERATE"

Means moderate: between the torrid tropics and the frigid poles. From Latin temperatus.

Real climates also depend on elevation, oceans, and winds.

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